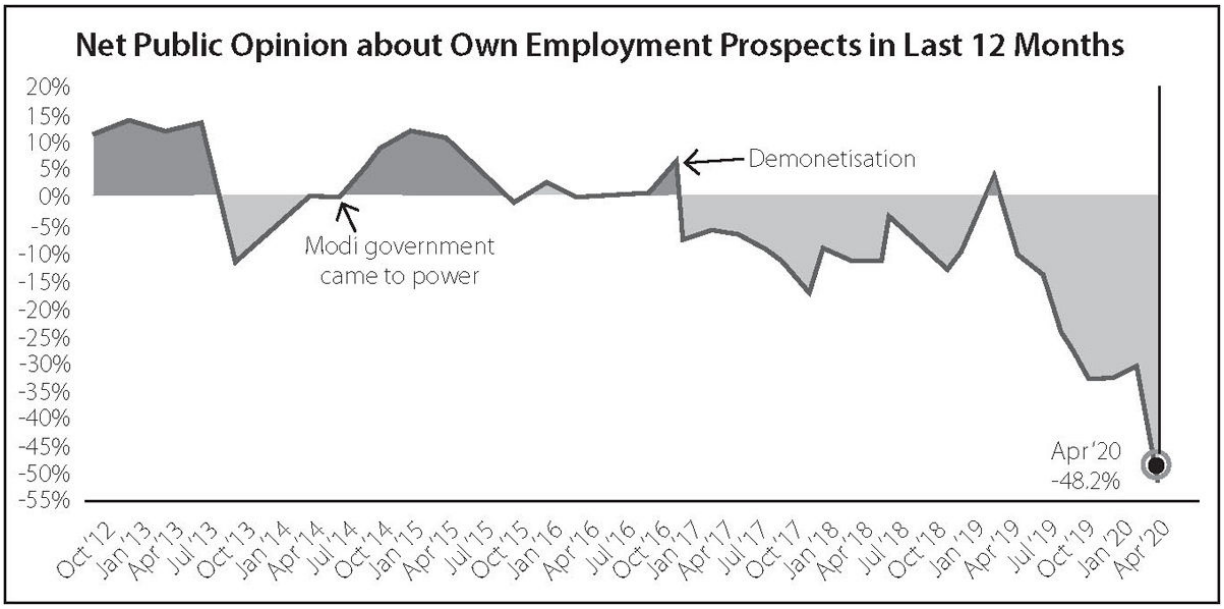
In fact, people's confidence in their own employment prospects fell to much worse than UPA-2 levels in 2017-18 before briefly recovering in March 2019 (see Figures 10.2, 10.3 and 10.4).

Figure 10.2. The Rise and Fall of Public Expectations about Their Own Jobs (2012–2020)



Source: RBI Consumer Confidence Surveys. Analysis and graphic visualisation by Rishabh Srivastava, Nalin Mehta: PollNiti. Available online: https://pollniti.com/data/rbi-consumer-confidence-survey.html

Yet, when the same people were asked about their future prospects, and that of the country's, as opposed to what they thought had happened in the past year, their opinions changed drastically. Unlike the complete despondency on this question at the end of UPA-2, net future expectations about the economy in India clocked in at 48.6 per cent positive in March 2019. This, astoundingly, was at a higher level just before the elections than it had been in 2014. Politics is about emotion and perception. It seems that, while people were personally unhappy in economic terms in the present, they were much more positive about their prospects in the future, as well as the overall economic direction of the country.

Now, Indians have historically been much more hopeful about the future than their counterparts in developed Western countries.[26]